

INTEGRATIVE LEADERSHIP THROUGH CONSCIOUS SELF MASTERY

**“THE PRIMARY TASK OF A LEADER IS THE MASTERY
OF HIS OR HER OWN ENERGY.”**

- PETER DRUCKER

QE - Facilitator's Manual - - Embodying Leadership Presence

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>> Context - Quantum Edge

QE Mission - To liberate the human spirit and enable the leadership of quantum change

- > Approach** - Develop intuitive servant leaders through the embodied practice of integrative presence and compassionate awareness.
- > Method** - The Training of Attention through Experiential Inquiry into the dynamics of Embodied Leadership Presence utilizing fun, curiosity generating, self validating, somatic exercises that source energy, control, power, influence and caring under the pressure of intense, complex change.
- > Foundation** - Based in research on adult development [R. Kagan], the domains of conditioned and unconditioned consciousness [R. Anderson] as well as mindfulness meditation [Levey], the martial arts [Aikido, Tai Chi, Chi Gung], the principles of living systems [M. Wheatly] and various east/west wisdom traditions.

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- > Applications - This body of work has been successfully utilized for over 45 years by leadership fellowships, corporate teams, individual executives and consulting professionals for addressing company culture design, organization strategy, systemic collaboration, team dialogue, R&D, conflict resolution, stress reduction, high stakes sales and overall resilience under the pressure of dynamic change.
- > Facilitator Kit - The set of core principles, mind/body practices and specific facilitator suggestions for teaching servant leadership through somatic development of grounded leadership presence and empathetic, caring relational dynamics and intuitive decision-making. It is recommended that new practitioners experience this work directly before attempting to facilitate it.

>> Somatic Tool Kit

SHIFTING DOMAINS OF AWARENESS FROM CONDITIONED MIND = OPERATING SYSTEM SOURCE OF REACTIVITY PATTERNS TO UNCONDITIONED MIND II EMBODIED ENERGETIC PRESENCE RELATIONAL FIELD RESONANCE OPEN INQUIRY

This manual is rooted in a few, simple mastery principles, that when practiced consciously, source embodied presence, compassionate awareness and openness to new possibilities. The mastery practices themselves provide a leader with the ability to shift domains of awareness from conditioned to unconditioned mind and to generate intuitive breakthroughs. With committed practice they provide for the realization of open awareness, producing capability for deep self leadership; empathetic, trusted relational and team leadership; and the holistic leadership of an organization, its culture and the spirit of the enterprise.

**DEVELOPING DEEP MASTERY
WITH ATTENTION**

**“THE PRIMARY TASK OF A LEADER IS THE MASTERY
OF HIS OR HER OWN ENERGY.”
- PETER DRUCKER**

**ONE CARDINAL ASSUMPTION
ENERGY FOLLOWS ATTENTION**

**THREE MASTERY PRINCIPLES
INSPIRED PRESENCE
RELATIONAL HARMONY
NOT KNOWING**

**THREE MASTERY PRACTICES
OPENING THE BODY
OPENING THE HEART
OPENING THE MIND**

The exercises in this manual are organized by the above principles and practices for developing Mastery with Attention. In this manual we work off the primary assumption that energy follows attention, and thus Mastery with Attention develops personal energy mastery for deep leadership presence.

ENERGY - SPIRIT / LIFE FORCE / SOURCE

Einstein said $E=MC^2$. In more common language, he said,

*"Everything is energy and that's all there is to it.
Match the frequency of the reality you want and you cannot
help but get that reality. It can be no other way.
This is not philosophy. This is physics."*

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These are radical times – radical, as in times of extreme change. Radical times require radical leadership – radical, as in fundamental leadership arising from the root, origin or source.

The origin or source of all things is *Spirit*,
the energy of creation, the spark of life, the light of awareness.

Mastery of Attention generates leadership rooted in inspiration, compassion and intuitive navigation of the ever emergent unknown.

Radical leaders seek the root cause.
They transform the world by transforming themselves.

>> Somatic Facilitation

Preparation - The best setting for this work is when the group sits in a circle. The exercises may require a room large enough for all the participants to move around in pairs or groups of three to five. Best group size - 5-30, though with multiple facilitators working with small groups of 15 [at times broken into pairs or 5s] groups over 100 can work well. Casual clothing / low heels.

Context Setting > Who / What & Why / How ?

Who - Clarify roles. Assure participants that all exercises are in slow motion and are *voluntary*. Request that the group support any one who chooses to add value to the inquiry as an observer rather than a participant in a given exercise.

What & Why - Name the exercise and briefly define its purpose and benefit. Exa: A shared inquiry into Attention Mastery or Investigating X energy principle, Y practice or Z question.

How - Briefly describe the exercise, its sequence and timing. Provide directions. Then demonstrate with a participant until they succeed. *Always request permission to make physical contact* and encourage everyone to do so with their partners. Let the group know that dialogue will follow the exercise to review the experience, raise insights, questions or challenges.

Timing - Combined these exercises can be orchestrated to form one or two day seminars, to unfold in hour or two long modules each day over a week's time, or be woven into other curriculum in 5,15, or 30 minute increments depending on debrief time.

Conduct Exercise - Invite folks to begin and check to see if people are following the instructions. If not, give them again or point out any misunderstandings and resume the activity. Facilitator roams sensing first for safety concerns, second for any coaching opportunities for the group or individuals, and third for the tenor of the group as a whole. Check in with observers to include them in the debrief as it unfolds. Stop the group to demonstrate refinement possibilities or coach an individual/pair before the whole group - fishbowl style. Track the time.

Debrief Dialogue - What Happened / So What / What Now ?

What Happened ? - First ask folks to describe their experience during the exercise. Collect several comments before responding. Draw them out to specifically describe their body experience as well as any thoughts and feelings.

So What ? - What insight or meaning is arising from the experience, or how might the exercise principle or practice be applied in their professional or private lives ?

Now What ? - Toward the end of sessions we often request that participants buddy up and design and commit to their own mastery practice, selecting specific principles or practices from the session with which they want to experiment.

With larger groups, small groups of ~ 6 can be used to address these questions as a pump primer before reuniting the whole group to hear the small groups' views and to summarize.

Summary - Review with the whole group the purpose of the exercise, what happened, any relevant points of emphasis, what possible applications surfaced and what commitments to practice may have ensued.

>> Somatic Exercises

OPENING THE ENERGY CENTERS OF THE HUMAN SOMA

**OPENING THE BODY
OPENING THE HEART
OPENING THE MIND**

In this manual, we follow the path of the spinal energy centers starting from the bottom up - Sacrum, Belly, Solar Plexus, Heart, Throat, Brow and Crown. In the Yogic tradition it is assumed that the path to health and liberation is to open each center and allow the natural flow of energy up from the earth and out the crown. Once this channel is open, one becomes capable of receiving the energy of heaven - natural enlightenment.

To use a more western metaphor, Ohm's law states that the amount of energy passing through a conductor is dependent on the amount of energy and the resistance in that conductor. Stress causes resistance in our system - the fight, flight or freeze response. When it's triggered, we experience increased long muscle tension, increased heart and breath rates, a racing mind and a narrowed field of perception. We literally clench our body and mind and lessen the flow of our energy. This reaction will save our life on the freeway, but it's killing us in the board room. These exercises serve as an antidote to the fight or flight response, opening the system for generative presence even under pressure.

MICROSOFT SESSION >>> COMMERCIALSALES
MARCH 9, 2017

ENERGY MASTERY
EFFECTIVE MESSAGING
CREATIVE THINKING

OPENING THE BODY - OPENING THE HEART - OPENING THE MIND
ENERGIZE HARMONIZE NAVIGATE

SESSION INTRO - CONTEXT . QE CADRE' INTRO - 10

WHOLE GROUP IN PLACE - CT - 10

III PRINCIPLES / III PRACTICES / I ASSUMPTION

INQUIRY / TOOLS: SENSE/IMAGINE

CENTERING - SCANS . PLUM LINE . PUSH TEST

CRUCIBLE I - 8 GROUPS 15 - 60

----- 15 -----

AIKIDO DEMO - WHOLE GROUP IN PLACE - 20

OPENING THE BODY

ENERGIZE 60 - 8 GROUPS 15 - ENERGY MASTERY

LUNCH - 60

OPENING THE HEART

HARMONIZE - 75 - 8 GROUPS 15 - MESSAGING

---- 15@45 ----

OPENING THE MIND

NAVIGATE - CRUCIBLE II - 60 - 8 GROUPS 15

CREATIVE THINKING

MASTERY DIALOGUE - 15 - 3's. -----

SUMMARY - W/GROUP - 15

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ENERGY MASTERY EFFECTIVE MESSAGING CREATIVE THINKING

OPENING THE BODY - OPENING THE HEART - OPENING THE MIND
ENERGIZE HARMONIZE NAVIGATE

ENERGY MASTERY
SESSION INTRO - CONTEXT - QE / CADRE INTRO - 10
III PRINCIPLES / III PRACTICES / I ASSUMPTION
WHOLE GROUP IN PLACE - CT SET
EMBODYING LEADERSHIP PRESENCE - 10

SENSING THE BODY
SCAN BODY / SCAN NEURAL CENTERS / SWEEP
CENTERING THE BODY
PLUMB LINE / PUSH DEMO

CRUCIBLE I - 60
INTRO CT - 10

BREAK - - - - - 15

AIKIDO DEMONSTRATION - 20

OPENING THE BODY FOR LEADERSHIP PRESENCE
CENTER / GROUND / FLOW - 60
ENERGIZING PRESENCE - INTRO - CT

CENTERING THE BODY - 5
REPEAT SCANS / PLUM LINE
IGNITING THE ENERGY
NATURAL BREATHING / BELLY BREATHING / SPINAL BREATHING.

GROUNDING THE ENERGY - 5
LIFT DEMO / SINKING OPEN / ROOTS & BRANCHES

GROUNDING TESTS - 10
REPEAT PUSH TEST / WALKING BACKWARD

FLOWING THE ENERGY - 10
HAND SENSING / EXTENDING ENERGY / EXPANDING FIELD
UNBENDABLE ARM TEST

SENSING RELATIONAL ENERGIES - 20
THE APPROACH
SUMMARY DIALOGUE - 10

LUNCH - 60

OPENING THE HEART FOR RELATIONAL HARMONY

RESONATE / BLEND / LEAD INQUIRY - 75

HARMONIZING ENERGIES - EFFECTIVE MESSAGING

INTRO - CT - 5

IGNITING PRESENCE - 10

CENTERING / CIRCLE OF POWER / PRESENCE CHECK

OPENING LISTENING SPACE - 10

STEP PUNCH / OFF LINE & SETTLE / OFF LINE SETTLE & ENGAGE

LEADING LISTENING - 10

WALKING PUSH / BLENDING ENERGIES / DEMO UNDERSTANDING

LEADING CO-CREATION - 10

DOUBLE GRAB PRESS / EXTENDING ENERGY / CO-DISCOVERY

BREAK - - - - - 15

BLENDING CHECK - 20

SPIRAL RELEASE

SUMMARY DIALOGUE - 10

OPENING THE MIND / VALUING NOT KNOWING

INQUIRE / LISTEN / INTUIT - 60

NAVIGATING COMPLEX CHANGE - INNOVATE

CRUCIBLE II INTRO - CT - 5

MASTERY PRACTICE DESIGN DIALOGUE

COMMITMENTS - 15

SESSION SUMMARY DIALOGUE

WHOLE GROUP - 15

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ENERGY MASTERY EFFECTIVE MESSAGING CREATIVE THINKING

OPENING THE BODY - OPENING THE HEART - OPENING THE MIND
ENERGIZE HARMONIZE NAVIGATE

SESSION INTRO - CONTEXT . QE / CADRE INTRO - 10
III PRINCIPLES / III PRACTICES / I ASSUMPTION
WHOLE GROUP IN PLACE - CT SET
EMBODYING LEADERSHIP PRESENCE - 10

Sensing the Body

> **Scan** your attention slowly around the body noticing where there's felt/sense [warmth, coolness, tingling. . .] and where there's not. Don't do anything about the blank spots, just noticing will generate more felt/sense.

> **Scan Neural Centers** - Scan the three major energy centers of the body [3 neural nexus / 3 brains]. Sense into the belly, the heart and the head. Let go of any tension in or around each center. Notice any differences. Which centers have felt/sense and which not ? Comfortable/uncomfortable ?

> **Sweep** the attention up from the ground, through the legs, up the spine through the belly, heart and head and sweep back down - notice any differences ?

Centering the Body

> **Plum Line** - Demonstrate rocking left and right, less and less and less until you align with your spine's center line. Release any muscular tension onto your skeletal frame and open the spaces between the vertebrae just slightly. Feel. Do the same practice forward and back. Wobble into center and release. Notice centerings effect. What sensations/feelings arise ? Try just sending your attention to one side and then back. You might try an Arm Grab/Sudden Change Test adding centering before and after the grab.

> **Push Test** - Select a volunteer and tell them what you're going to do. With their permission, push into their chest. Their job is to prevent you from pushing them back - without moving their hands or feet. Now demonstrate by standing next to them and pushing them on the upper chest. The first time go in quickly to draw their counter move forward to match your force. If they don't move then repeat and push them back.

This usually draws the counter when you try a third time. Point out flight, freeze or flight responses. Ask the individual and the group what they observed - likely collapsing back or countering by leaning forward.

Now instruct them to focus their attention down through their feet into the ground and 'lightening rod' the force of your push right down through their body into the ground - imagine roots. Push again and demonstrate the difference. Now ask the group to select partners and investigate these responses with each other. The task of the partner pushing is not to push them off center, but to rather to coach them to find their grounded center.

CRUCIBLE I - 60 - 8 GROUPS 15
WHOLE GROUP IN PLACE - CT SET UP

> **The Crucible** - This exercise provides an excellent live coaching environment. Here it is used as a pre-post testing experience. Used before teaching the principles and practices of Attention Mastery, it will reveal each person's go-to strategy/style when under the pressure of a complex, multiple force situation. Used at the end of a session, it functions as an evaluator and inculcator of what's been learned as participants declare the quality of leadership they want to demonstrate and step into the crucible to test their commitment and new found skills before their peers.

The Crucible is a simulation of leadership and mindfulness under the pressure of complex, unpredictable change. It's a comparatively slow group tag game that's been adapted to test Leadership Presence under duress. Tactically, the challenge is to calmly manage each given force and not to

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get tagged, but this will only produce avoidance or over control.

Strategically, the challenge is to demonstrate gentle leadership of the other players and even find a place to pause now and then. Finally contextually, the challenge is to discover how to compassionately lead the group as a whole system.

Ultimately, of course, the question is whether participants can let go of what they know and innovate, responding intuitively and spontaneously in the midst of the melee.

1. To help establish the relevance of the exercise, suggest that each participant select a difficult situation or person from their professional or personal lives that they will use for application inquiry.
2. Demonstrate with a group of four volunteers who will act as change forces, asking them to surround you in an imaginary circle about 12 feet across.
3. First demo the Force Role of the four people on the outside of the circle - have a volunteer stand in the center as the Responder Role and clasping your fists together and extending them out in front of you to form a spear, walk toward them. Show that if they don't get off the line, you'll tag them lightly - even if they duck in place. Then show and explain that if they get out of the way [have them do so], the person in the Force Role continues in a straight line to the other side of the imagined circle. *No heat seeking is allowed:* that is, they can't turn into the Responder as they go by or chase them.
4. When they get to the other side of the circle, they turn around and take new aim at the Responder wherever the Responder is at that moment. The Responder's new position becomes the new target line for the Force player and they come again holding to that line across whatever large or small cut of the circle that requires. Explain that those playing the Force Role will all be doing this simultaneously, and even if they bump into each other [and they will], they are to resume their line and continue once the traffic jam has cleared.

5. Ask for questions.
6. Now demonstrate the Responder Role. Step into the center and let them know that the Responder gets to control when the action begins and ends and the speed of the other Force Players. Invite them to come for you and demo moving smoothly amongst them. If the exercise is being used to reveal reactivity styles, don't demonstrate the full range of engagement options. If you're demonstrating for a coaching or evaluation round, then show not only facile movement but light physical guidance for redirection, the use of that guidance to engage the Force players with each other [using one to block another], finding the open space for pause and even aligning the force players such that they are affected as a whole system.
7. Ask the group to select partners in groups of 5 and investigate. Emphasize safety first. the most common problem is when someone from one group steps back onto the foot or ankle of someone in another group. *Establish a Safety Stop Signal* [whistle, clap or shout] that will be used to stop all action if needed. Warn them to avoid faces, glasses and women's chests.
8. After each player tries a round in the center of 30 seconds or so, the group should give the Responder feedback - first on how well their behavior/style/strategy worked and second on what didn't work about their approach. Then the next responder has their turn and so on until everyone in the group has played.
9. Once done the group should dialogue about what happened, what they learned about their style of reactivity and how their play relates to how they react to pressure in their professional or personal lives.

----- 15 BREAK -----

AIKIDO DEMO - WHOLE GROUP IN PLACE - CT - 20
TEAM AROUND MATS IN CENTER OF ROOM

I OPENING THE BODY FOR INSPIRED PRESENCE - 60

CENTER / GROUND / FLOW.

ENERGIZING PRESENCE - INTRO - CT

Centering the Body - 5

> **Repeat Scans & Plum Line** - Demonstrate rocking left and right, less and less and less until you align with your spine's center line. Release any muscular tension onto your skeletal frame and open the spaces between the vertebrae just slightly. Feel. Do the same practice forward and back. Wobble into center and release. Notice centerings effect. What sensations/feelings arise ?

Igniting the Energy

> **Natural breathing** - Breathe normally and place your hand over the area of most movement. Notice the differences around the group - usually heart and solar plexus, a few lower belly. Demonstrate a full breath, emphasizing the lower belly inhale and expand each area then slowly releasing as one.

> **Belly Breathing** - Demonstrate this core tool for presence. Placing your hands on your *lower* abdomen, push the belly muscles out when you inhale and pull them back in when you exhale. If you're doing it right, your hands will be moving in and out with the breath. Introduce Hara as power center.

> **Spinal Breathing** - Breathe into each of the seven neural centers from the bottom up: tip of the spine, lower belly, solar plexus, **heart**, throat, brow [behind the eyes], crown [imagine a point 2 inches above the top of the head]. Take a breath and imagine the inhale entering into each center,

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sense that center and then release the breath and with it any tension in or around that center. After breathing and releasing each of the spinal centers, take one breath up through all seven centers and release all the way back down with the exhale. Notice any differences. Which centers have felt/sense and which not ? Comfortable/uncomfortable ?

Grounding the Energy - 5

[[Lift Demo - Select a strong volunteer and tell them what you're going to do. Now demonstrate by having them step behind you and lift you under the arms and off the ground [think up, light or remember something from the past - in other words, get into your head]. Now have them repeat, but this time sink open and imagine your tree roots. Demonstrate the difference between grounded and not so grounded.

> Sinking Open - Take a deep breath, release along the plum line into the ground and sense any change in body awareness. Now release again, noting where in the body the release occurs and sense any change in body awareness. Repeat twice more giving time to sense the changes in the body each time. Notice that by the third or fourth time, the body releases itself without you knowing what will let go. Notice also that the deeper you go, the deeper the silence and the more folks will sense the field beyond the body [people around you, the room. . .].

[[Full Body Breath / Roots and Branches - Imagine tree roots extending down from your feet into the earth. Breathe up from the roots, up the back of the legs, up through the three spinal centers [G/H/H], out the branches of the arms, hands and fingers to just above the head. Now exhale down the front of the body through the centers and legs back into the ground. Reverse - thru the top and branches & down into the roots.

Grounding Checks - 10

> Repeat Push Check - Instruct group to Sink Open and/or visualize Roots and Branches focusing their attention into centering and grounding the body. Now ask the group to select partners and investigate these

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responses with each other. The task of the partner pushing is not to push them off center, but to rather to coach them to find their grounded center.

> **Walking Backward** - Select a volunteer and tell them what you're going to do. Now demonstrate several times by having them push you on the upper chest enough to walk you backward, each time showing collapse, resistance or ignore responses. Then demonstrate walking back in a centered, grounded way, attention in the lower belly - calm, collected, even slightly ahead of the pressure. Now ask the group to select partners and investigate these responses with each other.

[[**Group Hara** - Ask the group to walk about the room with thoughts of the past or future in their heads. Then, after a bit, as they're walking, request that they drop their attention into their lower belly and walk from there.

Flowing the Energy - 10

> **Hands Sensing** - Demonstrating, ask the group to extend one hand out in front of their body [thumb up] and then pass the other hand up and down across the plane of the first hand and sense for any change in sensation [heat, coolness, magnetic, energy, thickness. . .]. This provides the experience that our energy extends/radiates out beyond the skin of the body as science is only now beginning to measure.

> **Igniting Energy** - Sink open / Release and allow flow feeling to arise. Breathing in, imagine/intend/sense energy filling the body, and breathing out imagine/intend/sense the energy extending out the feet, heart, hands and eyes. Imagine roots and branches. Breathing in deeply, collect the energy into the lower belly, breathing out expand/extend the energy out from the belly, out the hands and feet and beyond the body. [[... Sun Squat...]

> **Energy Sphere** - Ignite your energy inhaling and sweeping attention up through the body as above. As you breathe out imagine a sphere of energy expanding out from the heart, beyond the body to surround others and fill the room. Breathe the sphere. Now sense into the relational field,

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empathetically noting the tenor of the field of those around you - try with a partner.

> **Unbendable Arm** - Select a physically strong volunteer with whom to demonstrate the two modes of response to intense pressure - resistance and non-resistance. Placing your wrist on their shoulder palm up, request that they bend your arm at the elbow down to their chest by increasing their force gradually [without snapping down] and allow them to do so. Now demonstrate resistance by forcing up against their down force. Point out that both of you are now working. Then demonstrate extended presence by flowing your attention up from the earth through the body out the arm and hands and through the wall. Point out that the more force they apply, the more you relax your shoulder and arm muscles and extend your attention out the hand demonstrating effortless power.

Sensing Relational Energies - 20

> **Approach** - Ask the players to line up in two lines with partners facing each other across an expanse of about 20 feet or more. Demonstrate with a volunteer. The receiver/sensor partner stands still and senses for any change within their body [energy field] as the approaching partner walks slowly towards them. As a sensation/feeling arises, they raise their hand to stop their partner's approach. Both players sink open to that change in their relationship field, and when the receiver is ready, the sensor drops their hand, inviting further approach. Demonstrate that once the approacher is standing directly in front of their partner [inches], it's important for them both to settle into the energy of that intimacy and not just break off or hug.

Summary Dialogue - 10

>

> **Lunch** - 60

II OPENING THE HEART FOR RELATIONAL HARMONY - 75

FEEL / RESONATE / BLEND

HARMONIZING ENERGIES - INTRO - CT - 5

Opening the heart requires vulnerability. Vulnerability requires the confidence to risk opening. That confidence arises from the deep presence produced by using the practices outlined in the prior section - Opening the Body. Share with the participants that all of the following relational exercises are dependent on their presence practice, the ongoing integration of their personal field - continuously returning to centering and grounding the body and breathing and flowing inclusive energy as they engage with others. Quick demonstration of Aikido: Entering with Presence / Settling, Blending and Leading / Opening into Not Knowing for Creative Possibility ["Creative Thinking - Intuitive"]

Igniting Presence - 10

> **Circle of Power** - Share this exercise as a quick practice for shifting into deeper presence. Have each player center/ground, breathe and feel into their body. Now have them imagine a circle out in front of them that represents the next level/sphere of power or energy, and when ready, they can experiment by stepping into the circle, centering, sinking open expanding their energy sphere / root and branch] and sensing for any difference in their experience.

> **Dynamic Presence Test** - Once they've stepped into their circle and taken their stand in their power, then have partners test each other with a one hand grab, pushing and pulling to check for centered, grounded, open hearted presence. Change partners / Repeat.

Opening Listening Space - 10

> **Step Punch** - Demonstrate a static step punch - right foot back steps forward, right hand delivers a punch to the receiver's midsection with enough intent that if the he or she doesn't get off the line, you still have power to move them back, but with enough care that there is no impact.

> **Off the Line / Enter & Settle** - Demonstrate getting off the line of direct contention [the punch] with a volunteer. Begin by standing facing each other. As the step/punch uncoils, step off the line of contention in any direction and sink open into a grounded center and open the heart. Explain that in stepping off the line we make our integrity more important than our previously established position, and in so doing, we deepen our integrity by re-centering ourselves positively in a new position, relaxing/releasing to open our energetic system and flowing out inclusively/compassionately from the **heart** center. Have partners investigate how this effects the power dynamic of the relationship.

> **Off the Line / Enter & Engage** - Now repeat, stepping forward diagonally off the line and in toward them. As you come in next to them, lay both your hands lightly of their near arm and Sink Open, releasing into your new, more deeply grounded, open **hearted** center. Then ask the group to select partners and investigate the dynamics of this metaphor for non-resistance to change and the empathy involved in releasing the tension of potential conflict and assuming another's view.

Leading Listening - 10

> **Push / Blend & Join** - Ask a volunteer to walk toward you with arm outstretched and push you on the upper chest strongly enough to walk you backward as earlier. Then have them repeat the walking push, but this time move diagonally off the line and in next to them. As you come in next to them, Sink Open and releasing the **heart**, put your arm around their shoulder and lightly taking hold of their near arm, assume their view, and join with their motion forward [do-si-do]. Ask the group to select partners and investigate the power of **open hearted**, non-resistance and going with the force rather than fighting it. [Step Punch can be used to increase the intensity by increasing speed and unpredictability]

Leading Co-Creation - 10

> **Double Grab / Add Energy / Third Way** - Have a player grab your forearm with both hands [like holding a baseball bat], ask them to lock you down and then demonstrate your inability to force them to move by pulling

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or pushing. Then show how **opening the heart** and flowing energy out both your hands moves both of you into a new, third direction by combining your energies into a single flow.

This establishes an embodied experience of compassionate collaboration before attempting to influence. Mention the metaphor of two rivers coming together to create a more powerful single flow that cannot be produced by either one alone. Ask the group to select partners and investigate the power of joining with the force of change [or another's opinion], demonstrating caring and thus gaining the jurisdiction to lead co-creation.

----- **15 BREAK** -----

Blending Check - 20

> **Spiral Release** - Demonstrate with four volunteers by having them stand close around you and place their hands on your upper body and push. Women may choose to cross their hands over their chest for protection. Let them know they can't grab, but they can adapt to block any moves you make to get out of the situation. First struggle to escape by making obvious strategized/engineered moves that they can move to block, then demonstrate blending by centering and grounding, **opening the heart** and through integrated non-resistance, allowing their different pushing forces to spin you out of their grasp. Don't collapse your alignment and don't force the move - Sink Open, retain your integrity and allow the energy to unfold naturally. If the group is in equal force stasis, ask them to push harder, to really push. Ask the group to select partner groups of 5 and investigate.

[**Walking Blend** - Ask the group to walk about the room with lower belly attention without bumping into each other. Now halve the space in which the group is moving. Now halve it again, and again until they are being challenged to blend.

Summary Dialogue - 10

III OPENING THE MIND / VALUING NOT KNOWING - 60

INQUIRE / LISTEN / INTUIT

NAVIGATING COMPLEX CHANGE - INNOVATING

CRUCIBLE II - INTRO - CT - 5

> **The Crucible** - Used at the end of a session, The Crucible functions as an evaluator and inculcator of what's been learned as participants declare the quality of leadership they want to demonstrate and step into the crucible to test their commitment and new found skills before their peers. W

The Crucible is a simulation of leadership and mindfulness under the pressure of unpredictable change. Tactically, the challenge is to manage each given force and not to get tagged, but this will only produce avoidance or over control. Strategically, the challenge is to gently lead the other players with compassion and even find a place to pause now and then. Finally contextually, the challenge is to discover how to lead the group as a whole system.

Ultimately, of course, the question is whether participants can let go of what they know and innovate, responding intuitively and spontaneously in the midst of the melee. To help establish the relevance of the exercise, suggest that each participant select a difficult situation or person from their professional or personal lives that they will use for application inquiry.

Set Up - Again emphasize safety first. the most common problem is when someone from one group steps back onto the foot or ankle of someone in another group. Establish a Safety Stop Signal [whistle, clap or shout] that will be used to stop all action if needed. Warn them to avoid faces, glasses and women's chests.

Once done the group should dialogue about what happened, what they learned and how this exercise relates to their professional or personal lives. The facilitator may choose to intervene in a given group to coach the

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player and allow them to repeat until they display the desired declaration, or select a group to do the coaching in a fishbowl configuration with the other groups watching in a surrounding circle.

> Mastery Practice Design Dialogue - 1:1:1 - 15

Participants get into groups of two or three and design a Personal Mastery Practice drawn from their own experience or one or two of the exercises they enjoyed during the session. Ideally, once clear, each player commits to a playful daily practice and chooses one of their fellow players in the session or someone to act as a practice partner.

> Summary Dialogue - WHOLE GROUP IN PLACE - 15